



Deciphering Harappan

Breaking down a most mysterious script, from one of the oldest civilisations in the world. <http://dg.it.in/nov20-75>



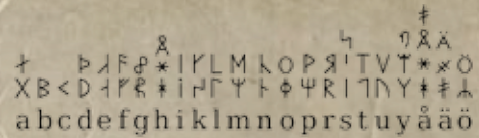
It's not gibberish

Find out the content of the ancient Norse text in Futhark, from the troll book in Disney's Frozen. <http://dgit.in/nov20-76>

Asch	ᐱᐱᐱ	a	His	ᐱ	i	Rehit	ᐱᐱᐱ	r
Birith	ᐅᐅᐅ	b	Gilch	ᐅᐅᐅ	k	Suhil	ᐅᐅᐅ	t
Khén	ᐱᐱᐱ	ch	Lagu	ᐱ	i	Tac	ᐱᐱᐱ	x
Thorn	ᐅᐅᐅ	ᐅ	Man	ᐅᐅᐅ	m	Hur	ᐅᐅᐅ	u
Eho	ᐱᐱᐱ	e	Not	ᐱᐱᐱ	n	Helahé	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	x
Féhe	ᐅᐅᐅ	f	Othil	ᐅᐅᐅ	o	Huyri	ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ	y
Gibu	ᐱᐱᐱ	g	Perch	ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ	p	Ziu	ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ	z
Hagale	ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ	h	Khom	ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ	q			

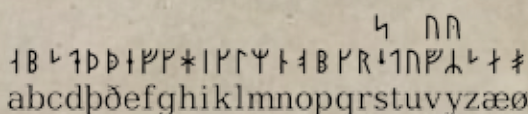
Marcomannic

The Macromannic runes are an evolution of the Younger Futhark, which was itself derived from Elder Futhark. In turn, the Marcomannic runes evolved into the Declarian runes. The runes are an attempt at representing all the letters of the latin alphabet by Carolingian scholars, which makes it suitable for use with modern English, and most other languages. There are twenty nine of these runes, which are each associated with particular meanings. The meanings of these runes had a significance when used for divination purposes. The procedure was relatively simple, where twigs were cut in half along the length, with the runes inscribed on the exposed inner sides. Then these sticks were thrown to address a particular problem, and the meaning derived from the combination of runes that landed facing upwards. Wilhelm Grimm, the younger of the Grimm brothers (the ones who wrote the fairy tales), found these runes inscribed on old rocks on his estate.



Dalecarlian

The Dalecarlian runes originated in Sweden, and were a mixture of Medieval runes as well as the latin alphabet. They were used from the 15th century and into the 20th. The runes by this time had acquired diacritics in the form of dots over the vowel sounds, and there were also curved runes, although the majority had the simple form factor made up of stems and branches. Also by this time, some runes were replaced entirely by their latin equivalents, including the letters B, D and M. Whether or not the evolution of runes from Elder Futhark to Dalecarlian represents one continuous lineage is a matter of scholarly debate, with some researchers suspecting that the Swedes merely began using the runes in tandem with the latin alphabet any way they could, based on old medieval texts, which explains the eccentricities noted above. Throughout history, runes were used as words of power. Examples include "strength" inscribed on a shield, "peace" on the doorway to a house or the family name etched into the blade of a sword.



Medieval

The Younger Futhark further evolved into Medieval runes, which were in use from the 12th to 15th centuries. By this time, even the runes had acquired signs with dotted variants, which are not very suitable for the original purpose of scratching on wood

or rock. However, with the simple addition of a dot or dots, it was possible to expand the rune set to accommodate more sounds. There was a rune for each of the sounds in the Old Norse Language, and the Medieval runes were used alongside the latin alphabet for several centuries. There was some drift in the usage and pronunciation of the runes, for example the nasalised a sound becoming the o sound. As such the Medieval rune set can be considered as the Futhark rune set with 16 runes, along with additional runes for extra sounds that were needed.